

**Are you Sherlock'd?**

BBC has hired a firm to use AI to track Sherlock fans across the world
<http://dgit.in/SherlockAI>

**e-Sports gets a boost!**

EA plans to establish a e-Sports division to create competitive experiences with games
<http://dgit.in/EAsports>

**PERFORMANCE****MICROMAX LAPBOOK** (₹13,999)

If you scoffed at the fact the Micromax is selling laptops, then the Canvas Lapbook will surprise you. While the device is of course not a hardcore performer, it'll suit basic users just fine. In terms of general performance, the Lapbook lets you continuously stream videos (between 480-720p) on it for over six hours, which is good for a laptop in this price range. Even while playing videos from the device's hard drive, the Lapbook can last for 6+ hours, which means you can get quite a bit of work done on the battery.

The Lapbook's downfall, as mentioned in the features section is that it doesn't come with any additional storage offers. In addition, the ASUS E402MA can perform slightly better than the Micromax Canvas Lapbook and is much better built. The area where the Lapbook really lacks though is in its display, which is sub-par to say the least. Still worth considering for first time, basic users.

XOLO CHROMEBOOK (₹9,999)

The XOLO Chromebook actually works quite smoothly and offers battery life that is better than the Micromax Canvas Lapbook. The device can go over eight hours when it comes to native video playback, while online streaming can be done continuously for over 7.5 hours. In terms of battery life, the XOLO Chromebook is undoubtedly the best out of the lot. At 10k, no other laptop that can provide this kind of battery life. If you're simply browsing and typing, this Chromebook would even last for 10 hours.

The Chromebook's weakness though is in the fact that it has no apps. While Chrome OS isn't the most difficult to learn and understand, the app support on Google's Chrome Web Store is really little right now. The Chromebook fits the bill for basic users, just like the Micromax Canvas Lapbook, but it needs a lot of work before we can adopt the always-online ecosystem of Google.

ACER ASPIRE ES1-131 (₹18,500)

The Acer Aspire ES1 lags one too many times at basic tasks, like clicking on Cortana to search for something. Of the four devices that we used, this one lagged the most and the fact that its keyboard is too cramped made it quite painful to use. While browsing on Google Chrome, we could hardly multi-task with a heavy website open in some tab.

It's actually quite sad, considering that the ES1 is the only laptop that gives the kind of storage that we wish to have on such devices. The 500GB HDD and 100GB of Drive storage would have been perfect for users like us, but the ES1's performance isn't quite up to the mark. That, when combined with the fact that the ES1 also costs nearly ₹2k more than the Asus E402MA, makes the E402MA a better laptop to buy.

In addition, the laptop also lacks in terms of battery life when compared to the other three that we chose.

ASUS EEEBOOK E402MA (₹16,990)

The ASUS E402MA is definitely the best performer amongst all of these laptops. It costs less than the Acer Aspire ES1 and provides over seven hours of battery life on streaming. In addition, its display is also the best in terms of contrast, colour reproduction and other elements. The device has a larger 14-inch display to boot and is priced at only ₹17k. If you're buying a laptop in this price range, then chances are you'll appreciate the bigger display and better build quality.

While the E402M does have the same processor as the Aspire E11, its performance is much better and the laptop seems much more prepared for Windows 10, which of course comes out of the box on this device. It doesn't lag as much and provides a comparatively seamless usage experience. If you have a budget above 15k, but below 20k, then this is the laptop that you should be going for. Hands down!

Benchmarks

BrowserMark.....	1324
Sunspider.....	914
Battery (Video).....	6.6 hours
Battery (Streaming).....	6.5 hours
Screen Quality.....	7 / 10
File copy.....	274 sec

Benchmarks

BrowserMark.....	2463
Sunspider.....	658.4
Battery (Video).....	8.3 hours
Battery (Streaming).....	7.5 hours
Screen Quality.....	6.2 / 10
File copy.....	230 sec

Benchmarks

BrowserMark.....	510
Sunspider.....	889.6
Battery (Video).....	5.8 hours
Battery (Streaming).....	5.2 hours
Screen Quality.....	6.2 / 10
File copy.....	61 sec

Benchmarks

BrowserMark.....	1037
Sunspider.....	800.3
Battery (Video).....	7 hours
Battery (Streaming).....	6 hours
Screen Quality.....	7.4 / 10
File copy.....	144 sec